E2 Speaking & Listening – Exam Prep Lesson 7: Describing people – Lesson plan and answers

Learners finish able to describe a person in a picture in an organised and polite way: age and build, hair, clothes, what they are doing and how they seem. This prepares Task 3.

Materials: Handout E2-7A, one per learner. Eight printed photos of people, numbered on the back: an older man reading on a bench; a young woman with a pushchair; a market trader serving a customer; two friends laughing in a café; a bus driver; a child in school uniform; a woman in sports clothes running; a family at a table. One extra photo for modelling.

Activity 1: Head to toe (25 minutes, teacher-led)

1. Show the modelling photo. Ask for any words. Write them on the board in four groups without labels: age and build; hair and face; clothes; feelings. Ask the class to name the groups.
2. Fill gaps in each group. Age and build: *young, middle-aged, elderly, in his twenties, about forty, tall, short, slim*. Hair and face: *long, short, curly, straight, dark, fair, grey, bald, a beard, glasses*. Clothes: *jacket, coat, scarf, jeans, trainers, uniform*. Feelings: *happy, tired, worried, relaxed, bored*.
3. Teach polite choices. *Elderly* or *older* is kinder than *old*. For age, guess with *about*. Avoid comments on weight: describe height and clothes.
4. Board the three verbs that carry a description and the pattern for each: *He is tall. She has long hair. He is wearing a coat.* Drill by pointing to features of the photo.
5. Common error check. Write *She has tall* and *He is a beard* on the board. Learners correct them.
6. Learners sort the words in section A of the handout and check in pairs.

Activity 2: Model description (20 minutes)

1. Learners complete the gap text in section B alone.
2. Check by reading aloud around the class.
3. Ask learners to number the five steps in the margin: who and age; build and hair; clothes; action; how the person seems.
4. Pairs cover the text and rebuild the description from the five steps.

Activity 3: Who is it? (25 minutes)

1. Put all eight photos on the board or wall, numbers showing.
2. Describe one in four sentences without giving the number. Learners write the number. Check.
3. Pairs take turns: one describes a photo, the other names the number. They must use all three verbs: *is, has, is wearing*.
4. Then describe a classmate's clothes only, without the name. The class guesses who. Rule: clothes and colours only, nothing about the body.
5. Board any clothes words learners needed and did not have.

Activity 4: How do they seem? (20 minutes, teacher-led then pairs)

1. Point to a photo. Ask: "Is she happy? How do you know?" Board the pattern: *She looks happy because she is smiling. I think he is tired because his eyes are closed.*
2. Drill *looks* plus adjective with five photos.
3. Teach guessing language for when learners are not sure: *I think, maybe, perhaps*. Assessors reward this, because it shows opinion.
4. Pairs choose three photos and say how each person seems and why. Hear several.

Activity 5: One minute on one person (30 minutes)

1. Groups of three: speaker, partner, timekeeper. The speaker takes an unseen photo and has ten seconds to look.

2. The speaker describes the person for up to a minute using the five steps. The partner asks one question at the end.
3. The timekeeper ticks the checklist in section C and gives feedback.
4. Rotate until everyone has described two photos.
5. Whole class: correct five errors you noted. Close by asking for the three verbs and one example of each.

Answer key, Lesson 7

- **Section A:** Age and build: tall, slim, elderly, young. Hair: curly, straight, grey, bald. Clothes: jacket, scarf, trainers, jeans. Feelings: tired, happy, worried, relaxed.
- **Section B:** 1 slim, 2 hair, 3 wearing, 4 reading, 5 looks, 6 bus.